

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus' body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.

 *Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.*

Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews,

⁵⁷ When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple: ⁵⁸ He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered

Jesus had a massive following beyond the famous twelve, including a 70-person "prep team" (Luke 10:1) that cleared the path for His ministry. Within that broader group was Joseph of Arimathea. He wasn't in the immediate inner-circle or the loudest voice in the room; he was a high-influence leader following Jesus on "quiet mode."

But real faith isn't about being the loudest—it's about being there when it counts. When his inner-circle disciples scattered after the crucifixion, Joseph stepped out of the shadows. He used his clout and resources to handle the King's business when many others hid in grief and fear, proving you don't need a "main stage" title to be the one God uses to capture the moment.

Reflection Question:

Have you ever done the right thing quietly, even if nobody noticed?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Prepared Before He Knew Why, Matt 27:57–60

⁵⁹ Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth ⁶⁰ and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed.

Joseph had already prepared a new tomb for himself. He likely thought it was for his own future—but God had another plan. Sometimes God has you build something in one season that He'll use for a completely different purpose later.

Reflection Question:

Is there something you've been learning, building, or doing that God might be preparing to use in a way you don't see yet?

Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus' body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. ³⁹ Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds

Joseph and Nicodemus were secret disciples that gave Jesus a burial of honor, even when it looked like everything was over. They chose reverence when others might have chosen to walk away in disappointment. Sometimes God sends the unlikeliest people to assist you in your transition. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a “condemned” Messiah.

Check-in:

Can you think on a time when your faith honored God even when you don't understand what He's doing?

Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42

So they took Jesus' body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. Then because of the Jews' Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

The stone and the sealed tomb looked like a "Game Over" screen, but they were actually the setup for the greatest comeback in history. Joseph's obedience in preparing that tomb became the physical evidence the world needed to prove the resurrection was real. Just when you think a situation is buried and finished, remember God is in the details, and your "prep work" matters more than you know.

Author's Commentary

Sometimes the prompt feels "silly," but obedience is the key to a chain of events only God can see. While stationed in Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, I felt a sudden urge at the altar to hug and speak life to a sister who was hurting. In my head, it felt random, but I chose to move anyway.

I didn't know that another woman in the service, Sister Williams, had just challenged God for a sign that He was still listening. She actually had a vision of me hugging that sister before I even stood up. Because I didn't let my "lack of action" get in the way, a chain reaction happened: the sister at the altar received comfort, and Williams received the divine confirmation she desperately needed. One "silly" step of faith can be the answer to someone else's secret prayer.

 Reflection Question:

Where in your life does it feel like a “stone” has been rolled in place—and how might God surprise you there?

 Dessert – Trusting What You Can’t See Yet

Joseph didn’t see the resurrection when he rolled the stone; he just saw a moment that required his faithfulness. We often think we need the full blueprint before we move, but we don’t have to see or know the whole plan for it to work out for our good. We just have to trust the One who does.

We know in part and see in part, but the more we lean into the God who sees the end from the beginning, the more fulfilling our story becomes.

 Reflection Prompt:

Write a one-sentence prayer:

“Lord, help me trust You with _____, even when I can’t see the outcome yet.”

 To-Go Box

- Quiet obedience still matters in God’s kingdom.
 - God can use what you’ve prepared in ways you didn’t expect.
 - What looks like closure to you may be a setup for God’s breakthrough.
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 Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Joseph’s example of humble, quiet courage. Help me to obey You even when it feels like no one is watching, and to trust that You are working behind the scenes. Use what I’ve prepared and built for Your purposes, not just my own ideas. In Jesus’ name, amen.”



Personal Prayer Space

Write a prayer asking God to use your gifts, resources, and preparation for His purpose:



Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the result it connects to.

Match		Acts of Faith		Results
	1	Joseph asked Pilate for Jesus' body.	A	What looked like a final seal set the stage for resurrection.
	2	Joseph rolled the stone across the entrance of the tomb.	B	A personal tomb became part of God's big redemption story.
	3	Joseph had prepared his own new tomb.	C	The burial honored Jesus and fulfilled Jewish custom and prophecy.
	4	Joseph wrapped Jesus' body in clean linen with spices.	D	Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor instead of being discarded.

Why Soul Food?



Dr. Dee Brown
Series Founder

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, **always brought both the food and the Word to the table.** You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call: ***Truth Served Daily***—sharing God's Word like Heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family, and friends, alike find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This Soul Food Bible Study workbook was born from that legacy. Designed for **personal devotion or Bible study circles, use in cell group ministry, and Sunday school settings**, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving “courses” to help you grow in wholeness, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in you with others. My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along. Be blessed!



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